Seed Quotation Checklist: Eight Commercial Terms to Confirm Before Approval · Practical guide

A seed quotation is easier to approve when it is read as a set of distinct commercial fields rather than as one headline price. An enquiry or an automated acknowledgement does not by itself conclude a purchase or confirm supply; the terms sit in the quotation and any later agreement. This guide sets out a practical pre-approval routine for resellers: checking each field on its own, keeping open points visible, and recording where each answer actually appears.

Why a quotation is not a single number

Treat the quotation as a structured record with separate columns, not as a price tag. Adding items to an enquiry basket and submitting the form only starts a review. An automated acknowledgement confirms receipt, not supply. Before approving anything, establish which document carries the binding commercial terms and distinguish that from catalogue information. A useful reference for that distinction is the guidance on enquiries, quotations and supply terms, which explains why a catalogue listing cannot stand in for a reviewed quotation.

The fields to verify line by line

Work through the commercial fields individually. Match the variety and requested quantity against the quotation. Separate pack size from unit, so that a price per kilogram is never compared with a price for a stated number of seeds. Record the quoted price, distinct from any catalogue price. Keep applicable taxes in their own field. Confirm shipping charges as a separate line rather than assuming they are included. Note documentation costs and who is responsible for documents, customs clearance, duties and taxes before any shipment is agreed. Read payment terms as a standalone item. Finally, check destination country and postal code, and treat a requested delivery date as requested, never as a confirmed commitment.

Give every item a visible status

One general note such as quotation received hides more than it records. Replace it with a short status for each field: confirmed in the quotation, agreed separately, awaiting supplier response, awaiting reseller approval, or not applicable. Attach the affected variety, field and destination to each open point. Do not close an item merely because an acknowledgement arrived. If a condition is unanswered, request it in writing and leave it marked pending. This keeps omissions visible and prevents unresolved conditions from disappearing into a general confirmation.

A pre-approval sequence that works

Build one row per variety containing requested quantity, pack size, unit, quoted price, availability and destination. This structure makes missing values obvious and prevents weight-based figures from being set beside seed counts. Add separate columns for taxes, shipping charges, documentation costs, payment terms, delivery arrangements, required documents and import responsibilities. Then compare the quotation against the destination, the requested delivery date and the documentation needs, keeping the requested date apart from any confirmed delivery commitment.

Closing open points in writing

Resolve pending fields in writing and record whether each answer appears in the quotation or in a later agreement. Complete the internal review only once every field is confirmed, marked not applicable, or logged as an explicit exception. An enquiry on its own does not settle supply terms. Reviewing fields separately makes gaps visible, preserves the distinction between enquiry, quotation and agreement, and keeps unresolved conditions from being lost inside a single acknowledgement.

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